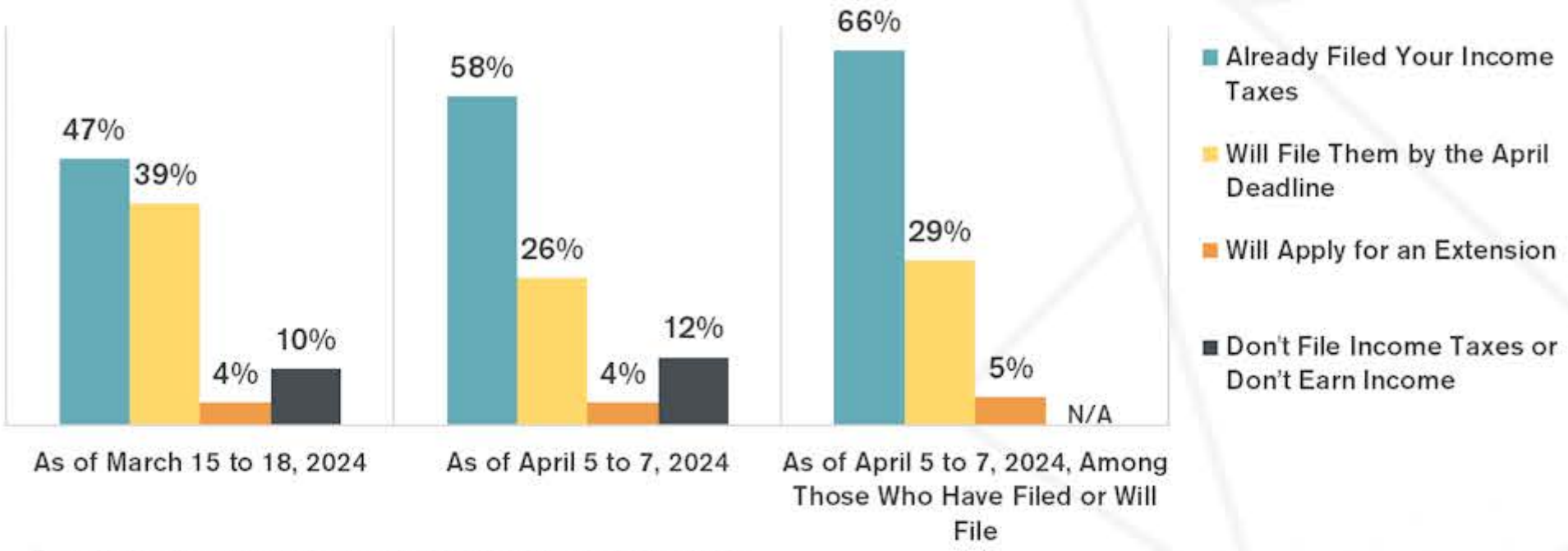
As of 10 days before the tax deadline, one-third of Americans who said they needed to file a tax return had not yet done so.



This included **29%** who said they planned to file by the deadline **&** **5%** who said they would apply for an extension.

New Research from the SSRS Opinion Panel Omnibus

How Many U.S. Adults Filed Their Income Tax Returns as of One Month and 10 Days Before the Deadline?



Base: Nationally representative sample of 2,012 adults aged 18 and older.

Expectation of Getting Tax Refund or Owing Money, Among Total Tax Filers

58% Refund

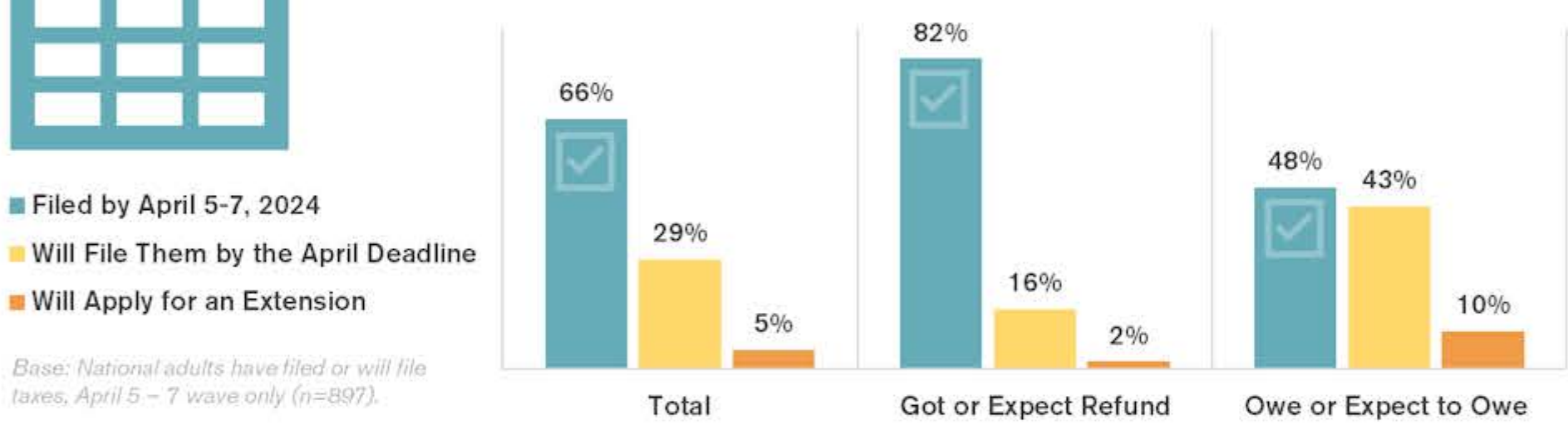
26% Owe Money

15% Not Sure Yet

Filers aged 18-29 (**70%**) and 30-49 (**60%**) were **significantly more likely** than older adults to **expect a refund.**

Base: National adults who have filed or will file taxes (n=1,810).

Those Who Expect a Refund File Their Tax Returns Earlier



Base: National adults have filed or will file taxes, April 5 – 7 wave only (n=897).

Online Tax Software Is a Popular Way to File

42% Online Tax Software

31% Accountant

When tax filers were asked how they had prepared or would prepare and file their returns, the most popular choice was using online tax software like TurboTax (42%), followed by using an accountant (31%).

Base: National adults who have filed or will file taxes (n=1,810).

Tax Refunds Are Especially Important to Younger, Lower-Income, and Minority Filers

Percent Who Say Getting a Tax Refund is "Very Important" to Overall Financial Situation

41% Total "Very Important"

Age		Household Income		Race/Ethnicity	
18-29	51%	<$50K	55%	White	34%
30-49	52%	$50K<$75K	40%	Black	59%
50-64	32%	$75K<$100K	30%	Latino	52%
65+	22%	$100K+	22%		

Base: National adults who are getting or expect to get a refund or not sure if they will (n=1,303).

How People Spend Their Tax Refund

45%

Nearly half of those who received or expected to receive a refund planned to use it to pay bills or debts.

Base: National adults who are getting or expect to get a federal tax refund (n=1,040).

Fairness of Federal Income Taxes Paid

Slightly more than half of U.S. adults believe they pay more than their fair share in federal income taxes.

53% Pay More Than My Share

5% Pay Less Than My Share

41% Amount is About Right

Base: Nationally representative sample of 2,012 adults aged 18 and older.

ssrs redefining research

Interviews for this study were conducted on the SSRS Opinion Panel Omnibus March 15–18 and April 5–7, 2024, among a nationally representative sample of 2,012 adults aged 18 and older. The margin of error for total respondents is +/- 2.44 percentage points at the 95% confidence level. The design effect is 1.25.

The SSRS Opinion Panel Omnibus is a multi-client, probability-based survey that fields twice a month. It delivers a nationally representative sample of 1,000 adults age 18 or older in English (with Spanish language option). Data collection is conducted online and via phone (for non-internet and web reluctant respondents) using the probability-based SSRS Opinion Panel. Learn more at ssrs.com.